The boss took a step or two towards me from the other side of the room. There was a boot on the floor. He swung his leg and kicked it. At me? At the wall? It could have been anywhere, he was that angry now. I felt a sting just over my left eye, where the boot had hit me. I put one hand up to it and found myself wiping blood off my eyebrow. I went for the manager. I don't know if I've ever lost control like that in my life before. A couple of the lads stood up. I was grabbed by Giggsy first, then by Gary and Ruud van Nistelrooy. Suddenly it was like some mad scene out of a gangster movie, with them holding me back as I tried to get to the boss. He stepped back, I think quite shocked at what had happened. Probably a minute, at most, was how long the real rage lasted. I calmed down a bit and went through into the treatment room.

One of the medical staff stopped the eye bleeding. I was in there for about five minutes. As much as anything, the doctor and the trainer were trying to make sure I didn't go back and start at it again. Eventually, I told them I was all right and went through into the dressing room. I got dressed and started to leave. As I got to the door, the boss was there:

'I'm sorry, David. I didn't mean to do that.'

I couldn't even bring myself to look at him, I was still that angry about what had happened and didn't want to react. I didn't say anything, just walked straight past and through into the players' lounge. Victoria was there. I wanted to get out of Old Trafford and home.

'What's wrong? What have you done to your eye?'

I told Victoria I'd tell her later but she wanted to know right away. I explained what had happened and, all of a sudden, Victoria was as angry as I'd been. She'd had to live with how low I'd been for most of the season. And now she thought she could do something about it:

'He can't treat you like that. I'm going to see him right now.'

I don't know what Victoria might have said or done if she had. I wouldn't want to get into a scrap with my wife. I knew it wasn't right to stay and insisted we left there and then. Later that evening, the eye started bleeding again and I had to call out the doctor. He came round and sealed the wound with a couple of steristrips.

I should have known what to expect. It's hard to keep secrets these days and, even before the Arsenal and United players had left Old Trafford that